

Task Claiming & Setup

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Before writing a task, make sure you have claimed the right task and can inspect the exact repository environment at the specific commit that the model will receive. Most setup mistakes create invalid tasks later, so resolve access, metadata, and repo-download issues before drafting.

Claiming Tasks

Claiming Rules

Before working on any task, you have to select and claim one. Follow the guidelines below depending on your situation.

Situation	Guideline	Tip
You are a new writer	Expect a claim cap of 2 inflight tasks until you have enough merged work.	Inflight includes tasks Claimed, Revising, Ready for Review, and Approved.
You have In Progress tasks	Work on those first before claiming a new task.	Revision and review loops should move before new work starts.
Available is blank	You are at claim cap, or no tasks match your selected languages.	Ask in Slack if this seems wrong.
Need another language	Ask the Slack helpdesk or Team Lead to add it.	Writers are not able to edit language choices after onboarding.

Task Dashboard FAQ

Use this section when the Airtable task dashboard shows unexpected results.

Dashboard Question	Answer
What are the dashboard sections?	• In Progress: tasks you already began; work these first. • Available: new tasks sorted by selected languages when tasks exist and you are below the claim cap. • Merged Tasks: previous merged work; use this to track progress toward 5 merged tasks (claim cap lifts) and verify payments.
The Available dashboard is blank. What is happening?	Usually one of two things happened: 1. No tasks are available for your selected language. 2. You reached your claim cap. If this seems wrong, ask in #code-qa-helpdesk on Slack.
How do I claim a task?	1. Open a task in Available, click Claim Task, and confirm it appears in In Progress. 2. Start working soon after claiming; tasks that sit in Claimed or Revising for many hours will be released for another writer.
I forgot to select a language during onboarding. What can I do?	Ask #code-qa-helpdesk or a Team Lead to add the language. Include the exact languages you want added. Writers do not have a self-serve UI for language changes after onboarding.
Which languages are available?	C, C++, C#, Cobol, CSS, Dart, Go, Hcl, HTML, Java, JavaScript, Kotlin, Lua, .NET, PHP, PowerShell, Python, R, React, React Native, Ruby, Rust, Scala, Shell, SQL, Swift, Terraform, TypeScript. Some languages may have no live tasks.

Setting Up Your Task

Setup Procedure

Use this procedure to confirm that your local workspace matches the task. You need enough local access to inspect the code and verify task-specific claims.

① Confirm task metadata.

Open the Airtable task and check the assigned language, repository, commit hash, task category/intent, and target difficulty. If any field conflicts with the actual repo (no repo in Dockerfile, commit doesn't exist, wrong language), flag it before writing. This is done by contacting a Team Lead or posting in the helpdesk channel on Slack.

② Authenticate and download the task.

Confirm GitHub access, run the Airtable clone/download commands, refresh expired S3 links when needed, and verify that the task templates are present locally.

③ Inspect the repo at the assigned commit.

Open the repository, confirm you are on the expected commit, and locate the files or modules that match the assigned intent. For example, if the task is about mini-cart navigation, inspect the mini-cart component, route definitions, and checkout/cart page handlers.

Common Setup Problems

Use this table to decide when to fix locally, refresh, or flag the task. To “Flag” a task, contact the helpdesk in Slack and/or a Team Lead directly. Writers do not have a “flag” button but Team Leads do.

Problem	What To Try	When To Flag
GitHub access fails	Run `gh auth status`. Confirm SSH access.	Flag if access cannot be granted or the task points to a repo you cannot inspect.

	Ask for repo/team access if permission is denied.	
S3 download fails	Click the Airtable button to generate a fresh S3 URL. Rerun the download command.	Flag if refreshed URLs still 404 or the task package is missing expected files.
Wrong commit or repo	Compare with Airtable. Check the remote URL.	Flag if the downloaded repo does not match assigned metadata, or is deleted on GitHub.
Docker/setup fails	Run only necessary scripts to set up the task (follow onscreen instructions during task setup).	Flag if missing files or broken setup (especially a Dockerfile lacking git commands or an explicit commit hash) prevents inspecting the behavior.
Language mismatch	Compare task language to the repo implementation language.	Flag with task number and correct language tag.
No usable repo	Check Dockerfile for a repo URL and checkout commit.	Flag if there is no valid repo or commit to inspect.